your app that caused an error, including the context of the error itself, but also the context in previous requests.

TIP Even with extensive logging in place, you may not realize you have a problem in your app unless you look through your logs regularly. For any medium-size to large app, this becomes impractical, so monitoring services such as Sentry (https://sentry.io) or Datadog (https://www.datadoghq.com) can be invaluable for notifying you of problems quickly.

If this sounds like a lot of work, you're in luck. ASP.NET Core does a ton of the "breadcrumb logging" for you so that you can focus on creating high-quality log messages that provide the most value when diagnosing problems.

26.1.1 Highlighting problems using custom log messages

ASP.NET Core uses logging throughout its libraries. Depending on how you configure your app, you'll have access to the details of each request and EF Core query, even without adding logging messages to your own code. In figure 26.1 you can see the log messages created when you view a single recipe in the recipe application.